



STRATEGY: MY STORY

taught skills like fashion design, web design, interior design, and more.

He adds, “Rohini is my backbone. You will witness a lot of positive energy if you enter our house. This is all thanks to the chanting of mantras she does and the environment she has created. She has always been my biggest strength.”

Though the couple has one son, Vyom, they recently got blessed with a ‘daughter’ in the form of their son’s wife, Rhea. A professional corporate lawyer, Sahni says his daughter-in-law has come as a blessing in their life. Vyom has followed his father’s footsteps and is working in India’s automotive industry with one of the biggest OEMs in its cost engineering and optimisation team.

Making India self-reliant in lighting

Though many leaders have spoken about India becoming self-sufficient in what it consumes, only a few have given weight to why it should be done. In the latter class, Sahni shares an incident from one of his previous organisations describing why India should be self-reliant. He and his team went to a potential European client for a project, and the timeline given by this company to develop a prototype for this project was four months.

Sahni, understanding what the client meant for his organisation and the nation, hired a European design house to develop the design and prototype of the project. On his flight back to India, he recalled and shared something that struck his mind, and he said to himself that this project’s success should not depend on one single design house. Hence, he told his team to start working on the same and also requested a professor from one of Mumbai’s premier institutes to work on the prototype.

“Four months later, we were at the door of the European client. At the last minute, this design agency told us the prototype was incomplete due to a last-minute glitch. None of us knew what to do at that moment,” Sahni says.

This professor that Sahni had met during a train journey in India had developed a prototype, and Sahni was carrying the same with him. He handed over this prototype to the European design agency and asked them to show this to the potential client as their work (European design housework).

“We got the project, but, more importantly, what we got was a lesson that though we could develop a lot in India, we still lacked the courage to present it as developed and made in India. We started the Self-Reliance Cell in 2008-09 in our organisation and have not looked back since then. I do not think there is any further example required to prove why we need to be self-reliant and, more importantly, confident about what we can achieve in India,” he says.

Today, his present organisation, FIEM, is making India self-reliant in lighting, but Sahni says there is much left to be achieved on that front. The thoughts of retiring had crossed his mind once, but not for long.

“Retirement thoughts crossed my mind, and stayed there for about 24 hours before I was working again,” he says, adding that there is no retirement for him! Next, he wants to help India develop talent, especially in engineering and new technology.

Also, he has set a new goal for himself, on completion of which he intends to invest in a sports motorcycle. Though he drives an Audi A6, a Bimmer, and a Range Rover, he also sees himself investing in a superior car pretty soon (as a reward for himself on completing a goal, probably)! **EFY**





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